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DREAM MACHINE | Creative AI News & Insight { July 2026 - Issue 38 }



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| Software Engineer



July 16, 2026

Welcome to edition 38 of Dream Machine. Covering **AI in the Creative Industries**: Film, Music, Games....

Created and curated by [DreamLab](#), a collective of artists, creative technologists, directors, games & software developers..... including Emmy winners, PhD researchers, and BAFTA recognised talent.

You can also listen to the [Dream Machine Podcast](#) 🎧 and for deeper insights and full on analysis, along with some predictions and advice about where this is all going... check out the [Dream Machine: Artificial Intelligence and the Next Creative Economy](#) Book, now updated to the 3rd edition.



Machine #41: Disney's J.A.R.V.I.S., AI's Generational Divide & The F

Preview Aug 11 • Dream Machine - Creative AI

Saved on Spotify

Editor's Pick: A Long Time Ago... Hollywood's AI Debate
Just Got a New Hope

This week, one of cinema's most influential voices stepped firmly into the AI debate.

George Lucas—creator of *Star Wars* and founder of Industrial Light & Magic—described AI as the inevitable future of filmmaking, comparing its critics to people who wanted to **keep using horses after the invention of the car**. Saying AI Makes Filmmaking 'Easier' and 'There's Nothing You Can Do About It'. He also criticised Hollywood's obsession with focus groups, arguing that audiences shouldn't be the ones making creative decisions.

BOBA FETT HUNTED INSIDE THE DARK PALACE | B

Star Wars: Lost Legends



Watch on

His comments arrive just as an independently created AI-powered *Star Wars*-inspired film is attracting attention across the industry, demonstrating how small teams—and even individuals—can now produce cinematic work that once required the resources of a major studio. The gap between blockbuster ambition and independent production has never looked smaller.

For an industry that Lucas himself helped transform through digital effects, CGI and virtual production, his endorsement carries weight. Whether you agree with him or not, it's another sign that AI is moving from experiment to mainstream production—and that the biggest shift may not be replacing filmmakers, but dramatically expanding who gets to make films in the first place.

Read more below



Video, Film, TV & Animation

- George Lucas Says AI Makes Filmmaking 'Easier' and 'There's Nothing You Can Do About It,' [LINK](#) he also likens AI sceptics to luddites clinging to horses and carts [LINK](#)
- The AI 'Star Wars' Film That Is Giving Hollywood A Wake-Up Call [LINK](#)

- An AI startup wants 'vibe directing' to become the new vibe coding [LINK](#)
- Creatives from 'Sharknado' and 'Doctor Who' Are Now Making AI Films [LINK](#)
- Will AI kill or save independent film? [LINK](#)
- 'What's left is you': AI is the elephant in the room of Europe's biggest animation festival [LINK](#)
- Homer Epic 'The Odyssey' Gets A Full-Length AI-Generated Film [LINK](#)
- AI-Native 'Lost Canon' Brings Raindance, CapCut and Moonmax Together for 10-Film Series [LINK](#)

Games, Immersive & Interactive

- Nvidia and Sega team up on games for RTX Spark AI computers — 30 years after 1st partnership [LINK](#)
- Breeze Creative unveils AI-driven interactive attraction, Magic Painter [LINK](#)
- Tencent to Lead \$2B Manus Buyback as Beijing Treats Agentic AI as Sovereign Asset [LINK](#)
- Pixel Ninja Turns Your Hand Into A Magical Shield With AI [LINK](#)
- Meta Pocket App Turns Descriptions Into Games and Every Play Into AI Training Data [LINK](#)
- China's Moqu Vision opens beta for AI-assisted game [LINK](#)

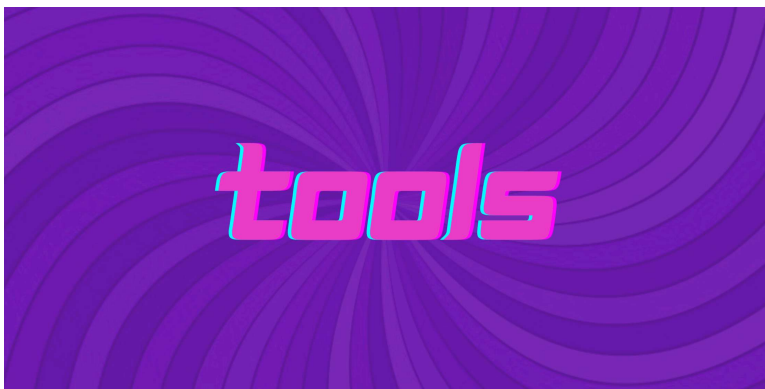
Music & Sound

- You can now control FL Studio with an agentic AI chatbot from inside the DAW [LINK](#)
- "Everything started from the hand of a human being": Italian DJ and producer Ciauru wins Reply AI Music Contest [LINK](#)
- Spotify is now an AI chatbot, too [LINK](#)
- Band Wakes Up to Find AI Has Stolen 94% of Their Spotify Royalties by Duplicating Their Album and Altering the Speed [LINK](#)
- ABBA's Björn Ulvaeus Says We Might Be Doing AI Licensing Deals Wrong [LINK](#) and 'Tracing the output was always the wrong question' [LINK](#)
- [LANDR](#) have just announced the next phase of their **Fair Trade AI** programme, a pioneering opt-in music-licensing programme aimed at independent artists [LINK](#)
- Is the most popular song played on Australian radio stations the product of generative AI? [LINK](#)
- "Think Google Docs meets a creative sandbox like Fortnite or Minecraft": Audiotool 3.0 turns its multiplayer online DAW into an open platform for creator-built music tools [LINK](#)
- RIAA, A2IM, IMPALA, and Others Announce Track-Level 'Labeling Program' for AI Audio, Target 'Broad, Global Adoption' Across DSPs [LINK](#)
- Session Musicians' AI Pay Clause Cannot Function, Warner Music Tells Court [LINK](#)

More Creative & AI News

Mapping the whole UK

- We're working on a new tool, called Soundings, that maps every creative company in the UK at street level [LINK](#)
- Chasing new skills, going back to basics and pushing for collective action: how software engineers are adapting to AI [LINK](#)
- Meta's Newest AI Tool Is Using Your Instagram Photos Without Permission [LINK](#)
- YouTube, X funnel millions of visits to AI deepfake 'nudify' apps, new study shows: Key findings [LINK](#)
- TikTok Targets AI-Generated Spam Accounts In High-Risk Topics [LINK](#)
- OpenAI launches a keypad for AI agents [LINK](#)



Tool Drops and Tutorials

- Google Releases Google Flow for Music [LINK](#)

MuScriptor

- MuScriptor from MireloAI and Kyutai Labs takes a finished recording, identifies the instruments playing, and returns separate MIDI tracks for each — voice, drums, bass, keys, and more. [LINK](#)
- Wan-Dancer-14B is now open-source! You can now generate long-duration rhythmic dance videos locally. [LINK](#)

Disney Generative Motion Rig

- "A Generative Motion Rig for Artist Driven Motion Authoring" from Disney Research Zurich and ETH Zurich [LINK](#)

Magnific Illustrator Plugin

- The Magnific Plugin is now on Adobe Illustrator [LINK](#)
- Voicebox - an open-source AI voice studio.Clone any voice. Generate speech. Dictate into any app. Talk to agents in voices you own. [LINK](#)

Higgsfield MCP in After Effects

- Use Claude Code inside After Effects with the Higgsfield MCP [LINK](#)

- ComfyUI PowerPanel- another workflow and quality of life simplifier. Collapses every node into one clean control panel [LINK](#)
 - Gemini in Google Chrome is launched in the UK, bringing the latest AI features to your desktop. [LINK](#)
 - SCENA by Lightricks. Reference driven multi speaker audio scene generation [LINK](#)
-

LTX 2 Crossview Lora

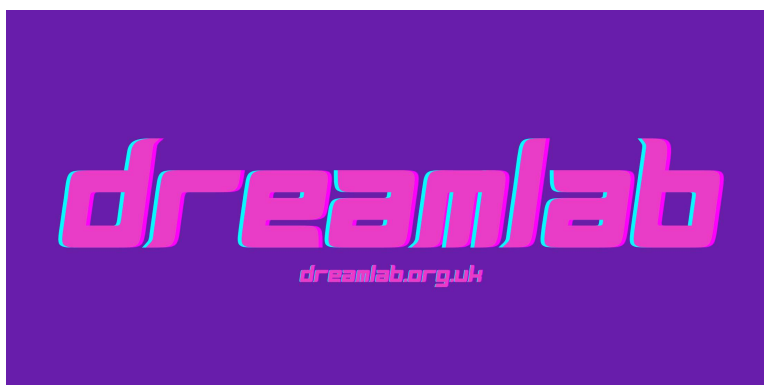
- LTX2.3 CrossView LoRA [LINK](#)
- LingBot-World 2.0 - World Model [LINK](#)

NVIDIA ARDY

- ARDY is NVIDIA's new AI model for real-time interactive human motion generation. [LINK](#)

Next Time...

If you've got any recommendations, opportunities or news we need to know about for our next edition please feel free to reach out.



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Audio/Podcast version here <https://open.spotify.com/episode/74kDDKIEFTGMUhV0bJlhk2?si=caa406bcaa3643e0>

Dream Machine #38 | George Lucas Backs AI, Star Wars' AI Wake-Up Call & The Future of Creative...

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